



YOU ARE **35 WEEKS EXACTLY** 35 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby's brain continues to mature. This image shows that the folding pattern overlying the cerebral hemispheres has now developed, giving rise to the familiar folds and grooves on the brain's surface. The bright reflections are from the bony skull.

“The reality of being a mother will begin to hit you in these final weeks, and you have everything to look forward to.”

Before the birth, it can be difficult to imagine having a relationship with your baby, even though you may feel a close bond during pregnancy.

Fortunately, bonding is a chemical process in your brain when you give birth. Other people's babies may leave you feeling cold, but it's highly likely that your own baby will spark all kinds of feelings that you never even knew you could experience.

It's normal to worry about being a mother—coping with the responsibility, taking care of a helpless baby, being “good enough,” and making lifestyle changes. However, when your baby is born, your priorities will become abundantly clear, as will your affections—although bonding may not always be instant.

In some cases, [postpartum depression](#), or even the short-term baby blues (see [First outing](#)), can interrupt the natural progression of feelings a mother has for her newborn baby.

PAMPER YOURSELF

You may not feel particularly lovely, but that's all the more reason to pamper yourself. There's unlikely to be time for beauty rituals once the baby is born.

- **Treat yourself to a manicure**, but don't have nail extensions for when your baby is born—sharp implements and babies don't mix.
- **Indulge in a facial**: it will make you feel good and help you relax.
- **Have your hair cut** since it may be some time before you get to the hairdresser again. It's a good idea to opt for a style that will be easy to manage once your baby arrives.
- **If you have aches and pains**, book a massage with someone who specializes in pregnancy.
- **Have a pedicure** a week or two before the birth. You'll be thrilled once your belly is gone and you're able to see your feet again.

ASK A DOCTOR
